

CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY

WRITING & COMMERCE

The Practical Handbook Series

Ghostwriting

Get paid well to write - while someone else takes the credit.

You will learn to find clients, capture anyone's voice, write blogs, social posts and scripts, price your work properly, and build a portfolio that lands paid gigs.

8 CHAPTERS - SELF-STUDY GUIDE - PRACTICAL EXERCISES

Wambete Benjamin

Founder, CHRISCO Digital Academy - Jinja & Buikwe, Uganda - 2026 Edition

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A note before you begin

Busy people - founders, executives, influencers - have ideas and audiences but no time to write. They pay ghostwriters to turn their thoughts into polished content published under their name. If you can write clearly, this is one of the fastest ways to earn real money online with your words.

Ghostwriting is invisible by design: you do the work, they get the credit, and you get paid - often very well. The trade is fair, because your name lives in your bank balance and your private portfolio, not the byline.

You do not need to be a literary genius. You need to write clearly, meet deadlines, and sound like your client. This book shows you how, and pushes you to build the portfolio that gets you hired.

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HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Read one chapter at a time. Don't just read - do the 'Try This' exercise in each chapter before you move on, and keep your answers in a notebook. The 'In Practice' stories show how the idea works in real life. By the last page you should have real work to show, not just notes.

What is ghostwriting

A ghostwriter writes content that is published under someone else's name - blog posts, LinkedIn updates, newsletters, books, speeches, video scripts. The client provides ideas, expertise or a rough voice note; you turn it into finished writing in their voice. You stay invisible, and that invisibility is exactly what clients pay a premium for.

The work is in demand because good writing takes time and skill that busy, successful people lack. Content is how they build authority and attract customers, so they happily pay someone reliable to produce it. Understanding that you are selling time, clarity and consistency - not just words - helps you value the work correctly.

IN PRACTICE

Many popular LinkedIn thought-leaders and busy CEOs do not write their own posts. A ghostwriter takes a 5-minute voice note of their ideas and turns it into a polished post - and earns a healthy monthly fee for doing it a few times a week.

TRY THIS

Find three pieces of content online (a blog, a LinkedIn post, a newsletter). For each, imagine you were hired to write it - what ideas would the client have given you?

Key takeaways

- Ghostwriters write under the client's name.
- Clients pay a premium for invisibility and reliability.
- You sell clarity and consistency, not just words.

Finding ghostwriting clients

Clients are everywhere content is needed: startup founders, coaches, consultants, agencies and influencers. Find them on LinkedIn, freelance platforms, and by watching who posts inconsistently or writes poorly but has something to say - they are your ideal prospects. Reach out with a specific, helpful message, not a generic 'I write content' blast.

The best long-term clients come from proof and referrals. Start by writing sample pieces (even for imaginary clients) to show your range, offer a small first project to build trust, and always ask happy clients for referrals. Ghostwriting is a relationship business - one good client who keeps you on retainer beats ten one-off gigs.

IN PRACTICE

A beginner messaged ten founders whose LinkedIn pages were quiet, offering to write three posts as a paid trial. Two said yes; one became a monthly retainer client. Specific, targeted outreach beat waiting to be discovered.

TRY THIS

Identify five people online who clearly need writing help. Draft a short, specific outreach message offering to help one of them.

Key takeaways

- Target people who need content but lack time.
- Personal, specific outreach beats generic blasts.
- Retainers and referrals build a stable income.

Writing in someone else's voice

The core ghostwriting skill is sounding like your client, not like you. Before writing, study how they speak and write: their common phrases, tone (formal or casual), sentence length, and the stories they tell. Collect samples, listen to their voice notes or interviews, and build a mental (or written) profile of their voice.

Then write as them, not as yourself - resist inserting your own style. Read your draft aloud and ask, 'Would they actually say this?' The goal is that even their close colleagues cannot tell someone else wrote it. Nailing a client's voice is what turns a one-off writer into a trusted, well-paid long-term partner.

IN PRACTICE

A ghostwriter kept a one-page 'voice sheet' for each client - favourite words, tone, do's and don'ts. Clients regularly said 'this sounds exactly like me' - which is the highest praise a ghostwriter can earn, and what kept them paying.

TRY THIS

Pick a public figure with a distinct style. Study three of their posts, then write a new post in their voice so convincingly it could pass as theirs.

Key takeaways

- Write as the client, not as yourself.
- Study their words, tone and stories first.
- Nailing their voice earns long-term trust.

Blog and article ghostwriting

Blogs and articles are bread-and-butter ghostwriting work. A good article has a clear purpose, a strong headline, a hook that pulls the reader in, well-organised points with subheadings, and a satisfying close. Even when writing in a client's voice, you bring the structure and clarity that keeps readers reading to the end.

Research matters: you often write about topics you are not an expert in, so you must quickly gather accurate information and present it clearly (verifying facts, especially if using AI to help). Deliver clean, well-structured, error-free drafts on time, and clients will keep coming back - reliability is as valued as talent.

IN PRACTICE

A client gave a ghostwriter bullet points and a voice note. She turned them into a clear, well-structured 800-word article with a strong headline and subheadings. The client published it unchanged - and hired her for three more.

TRY THIS

Take a topic you know a little about. Write an 800-word article with a strong headline, a hook, subheadings and a clear conclusion.

Key takeaways

- Bring structure and clarity to every article.
- Research and verify what you write.
- Clean drafts on time win repeat work.

Social media ghostwriting

Short-form ghostwriting - especially LinkedIn and X posts - is booming and often the easiest to start with. The skill is packing a clear idea or story into a scroll-stopping few lines: a strong first line (the hook), a valuable or relatable middle, and a point or call to engagement at the end. Every word must earn its place.

Consistency is the client's real need, so many social ghostwriting gigs are retainers - a set number of posts per week. Learn each platform's style (LinkedIn rewards insight and stories; X rewards punchy takes), keep a bank of the client's ideas to draw from, and schedule ahead. Reliable, on-brand posts week after week are worth a steady monthly fee.

IN PRACTICE

A ghostwriter charges a monthly retainer to write eight LinkedIn posts for a consultant from his voice notes. It takes her a few hours a week, the client's following grows, and both are happy - the model that makes social ghostwriting so profitable.

TRY THIS

Write three LinkedIn-style posts (hook, value, engagement prompt) for a client persona - each under 150 words and each with a scroll-stopping first line.

Key takeaways

- Short-form ghostwriting is easy to start and in demand.
- Master each platform's style.
- Consistent posts on retainer are steady income.

Scriptwriting for YouTube

Video creators need scripts, and many hire ghostwriters. A video script is different from an article: it is written for the ear and the eye, with a powerful hook in the first 15 seconds, a conversational tone, clear visual cues, and a pace that never lets the viewer drift. You write words meant to be spoken and watched, not read silently.

Structure the script to hold retention: open with the payoff, deliver value in tight sections, and guide toward the video's goal (subscribe, click, buy). Write in the creator's speaking voice and mark where visuals or emphasis go. Good script ghostwriters are valuable because a strong script is most of a video's success - and creators know it.

IN PRACTICE

A faceless-channel owner outsources scripts to a ghostwriter who nails the hook and pacing. The channel's watch-time rose after switching to her scripts, so she now writes several a week - well-paid, invisible work behind a growing channel.

TRY THIS

Write a 2-3 minute YouTube script on a topic of your choice: a 15-second hook, clear spoken-style sections, and a closing call to action.

Key takeaways

- Scripts are written for the ear and eye.
- Hook in 15 seconds; write to hold retention.
- Strong scripts are most of a video's success.

Pricing and contracts

Beginners undercharge out of fear; do not. Price by the value and time involved, and move toward per-project or monthly retainer pricing rather than tiny per-word rates. As you build proof, raise your rates. Clients often respect a confident, fair price more than a suspiciously cheap one - low prices can signal low quality.

Protect yourself with clear agreements, even simple ones: scope (what and how much), price, deadlines, number of revisions, and payment terms (ask for a deposit upfront). Put it in writing before you start. Clear terms prevent the two biggest ghostwriting headaches - endless free revisions and clients who vanish before paying.

IN PRACTICE

A ghostwriter switched from charging per word to a monthly retainer with a set number of posts, a two-revision limit and a 50% deposit. Her income became predictable and disputes disappeared - all from a one-page written agreement.

TRY THIS

Write your simple service agreement template: scope, price, deadline, revision limit and payment terms. Use it on your next client.

Key takeaways

- Price on value; prefer projects and retainers.
- Raise rates as your proof grows.
- Always agree scope, revisions and deposit in writing.

Build your full portfolio

Your portfolio is what gets you hired, and you can build it before you have a single client by writing sample pieces: a blog post, a set of social posts, a video script, maybe a newsletter - each showing you can capture a voice and deliver clean work. Put your best pieces somewhere easy to share (a simple document or site).

Because ghostwriting is confidential, use samples, anonymised work (with permission), or self-made pieces rather than naming clients. Aim for range and quality over quantity - a handful of excellent, varied samples proves more than a pile of mediocre ones. With a strong portfolio and confident outreach, paid work follows.

IN PRACTICE

A newcomer with zero clients wrote five polished samples across blogs, LinkedIn and a script. That portfolio alone convinced a founder to hire her - proof, not experience, opened the door, and the experience followed.

TRY THIS

Create a portfolio of at least four varied writing samples (article, social posts, script, newsletter). Put them in one shareable document or page.

Key takeaways

- Build a portfolio even before your first client.
- Show range: article, social, script, newsletter.
- Quality and variety beat quantity.



KEEP GOING

Skills pay for life. Now go use them.

Finishing the reading is not the goal - finishing the project is. Pick the one exercise in this book that scared you most and do it this week. Then bring your work to your CHRISCO facilitator or post it online. That single habit - shipping real work - is what separates the youth who earn from the youth who only dream.

CHRISCO Digital Academy

Jinja & Buikwe, Uganda - shambetz@gmail.com

WhatsApp +256 763 393 021 / +256 755 467 513 - Under CHRISCO Youth Aflame - Founder:
Wambete Benjamin